Police shootings and public parades after Bengal's 2026 government change

A descriptive four-state comparison of detected Times of India cases
Observation endpoint: 27 October 2026 (Indian event dates)

The pipeline identifies three West Bengal shootings after alleged officer-gun-taking in the post-change window, versus none identified there before it. This is an association in detected reporting. The current data do not identify an effect caused by BJP rule.

What the numbers measure

A case is an event, not an article or a person. The main outcome requires a report that an accused took or attempted to take an officer's firearm and was then shot by state police. Fatal and nonfatal shootings are both eligible; the four qualifying events identified across the entire cohort happen to be fatal. Police accounts remain claims, not established facts or legal findings of extrajudicial killing.

State	Pre: Jan 2024-Apr 2026 (851 days)	Same season: Jun 1-Oct 27 2025 (149 days)	Post: Jun 1-Oct 27 2026 (149 days)
West Bengal	0	0	3
Kerala	0	0	0
Tamil Nadu	0	0	0
Telangana	1	1	0

Every zero means no qualifying positive detected by this fixed pipeline; it does not mean no actual event occurred. The unequal pre/post durations are shown explicitly. May 2026 is excluded from the main monthly fit because the government changed during that month.

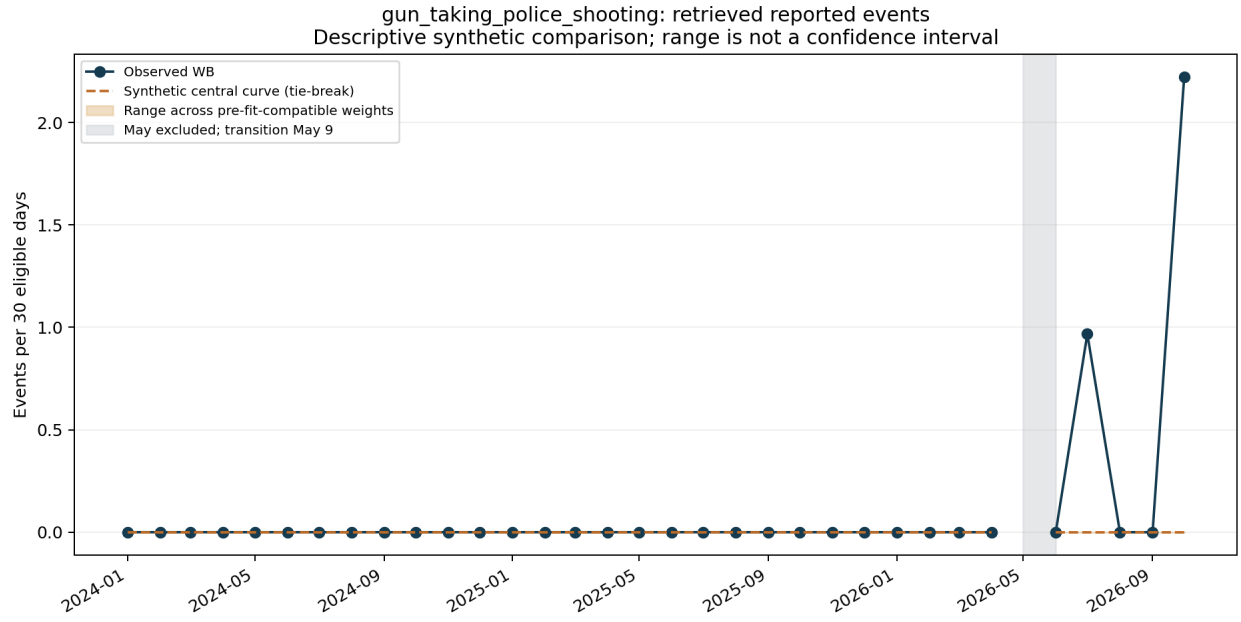
The four main reported events

Event date	State / event	Claim and source
20 Oct 2025	Telangana / Nizamabad	TOI reporting Hospital custody; attempted/completed taking differs.
8 Jul 2026	WB / Baruipur	TOI reporting Crime-scene reconstruction; some early date wording conflicts.
27 Oct 2026*	WB / Gaighata	TOI reporting Reconstruction; overnight chronology requires caution.
27 Oct 2026*	WB / Shamsherganj	TOI reporting CID reconstruction; detailed report gives 14:30.

*The paired October 27 chronology is provisional; publication dates remain separate from event dates. One combined report describes both events. Repeated articles and variant spellings have been collapsed. The March 2025 BSF border case is excluded from the state-police outcome.

A synthetic comparison with weak pre-period information

West Bengal is compared with Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Telangana using only pre-change outcome histories to choose weights.



Monthly detected cases per 30 eligible days. October 2026 includes 27 days; May 2026 is omitted. The displayed band spans weights compatible with the specified pre-fit rule. It is not a confidence interval, a causal bound, or an allowance for missed cases.

What the fit actually learns

West Bengal has an all-zero detected pre-period. Kerala and Tamil Nadu also have all-zero pre histories, while Telangana has the October 2025 Riyaz event. An exact match to West Bengal puts essentially zero weight on Telangana, but cannot distinguish any mixture of Kerala and Tamil Nadu. Each of those two donors can have any weight from 0 to 1. The central 50/50 mixture is a computational tie-break, not a uniquely learned counterfactual.

All three donors have zero detected cases in the post-period. Consequently every pre-fit-compatible mixture predicts zero there. West Bengal has three detected cases over 149 days: **0.604 detected cases per 30 days**, versus zero for the synthetic series. The pooled cumulative gap is three detected events. Its numerical stability across these weights does not establish causal identification.

Why this is not a BJP effect estimate

The observed cluster motivated this exploratory comparison. There is one treated state, three selected donors and no informative treated pre-event pattern. Reporting intensity, political salience, police custody/reconstruction opportunities and lexical recall may change across time and states. No prisoner-transport or reconstruction denominator is available. Flat detected pre-counts do not establish comparable trends in underlying misconduct.

No significance test is reported. With four state labels, a treatment-label rank comparison has only four possible ranks; exchangeability is not justified here. Better evidence would need comparable source ascertainment, independently checked event coding, longer informative histories, exposure denominators and a defensible untreated comparison group.

Public parades: three definitions give different counts

The label must separate police action from private mobs, reconstruction from other escorts, and described clothing from unknown clothing.

Detected police event label	Pre: Jan 2024-Apr 2026	Post: Jun 1-Oct 27 2026	From May 9-Oct 27 2026
Broad explicit police public parade	0	4	5
Public parade explicitly linked to reconstruction	0	3	3
Reconstruction plus explicitly shirtless	0	1	1

For all three labels, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Telangana have zero detected qualifying events in these windows. Those are pipeline counts, not proof of absence. The June-start broad count is four; including May adds Bonny/Roy and gives five.

The five identified West Bengal public-parade reports

Date / subject	Clothing reported	Reconstruction explicit?
28 May 2026 / Bonny/Roy	Sleeveless vest, Bermuda shorts, waist rope	No; police probe described
11 Jun 2026 / Jahangir Khan	White T-shirt and Bermuda shorts	Yes
2 Jul 2026 / Saokat Molla	Not described	Yes
18 Jul 2026 / Tirthankar Ghosh	Not described	No; investigation described
27 Oct 2026 / Three Behala accused	Shirtless, barefoot, waist ropes	Yes

Unknown clothing is not evidence that clothing was ordinary. It simply fails the strict reported-shirtless label. The separate October 25 Behala naked parade was allegedly by relatives/associates; the October 27 police parade concerns men accused in that earlier incident. The two episodes must not be merged.

A documented earlier example, and a capture warning

TOI, Behror, Rajasthan (published 23 September 2019) describes thirteen accused taken through public streets in innerwear, barefoot, on Sunday 22 September 2019. The superintendent of police explicitly described recreation of the crime scene. This is one episode involving thirteen people, and establishes that the reconstruction-and-underclothing narrative predates the 2026 Bengal cluster; no party attribution is inferred here.

External reporting describes Howrah police reconstruction parades around 24-25 May 2026, with episode identity/date uncertainty. These are outside this fixed TOI-derived panel and are not added to its counts: a completed pipeline remains an incomplete event census.

How to read this comparison

Political exposure and control selection

Treatment means a BJP chief minister in office on the event date. The official oath date for West Bengal is 9 May 2026. This definition differs from BJP cabinet participation, central influence, alliance membership or a BJP-appointed governor. The BSF sensitivity event therefore remains separate from state-police outcomes.

Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Telangana form a transparent feasibility subset of states without a BJP chief minister, not the full universe of states where BJP has never been in power. Cabinet histories and alliances require separate coding. Tamil Nadu and Kerala also had non-BJP government turnovers in May 2026 (Vijay on 10 May; V.D. Satheesan on 18 May). They remain donors under the stated BJP-CM definition, but those contemporaneous changes can affect comparability.

What was completed, and what remains unknown

A symmetric URL screen selected 1,132 unique TOI article IDs from the public sitemap inventory; all had available headline, date and body metadata. The independent expanded firearm/taking, reconstruction and parade screen flagged 245 articles, all of which received AI source-context review. Repeated reports were joined into event records, and actual event geography and state/central/private actors were separated. There are no unread positive-signal candidates.

An independent AI agent read a stratified random 48 available low-signal bodies (12 per state; seed 20261027): no visible missed target shooting or underclothed reconstruction parade was found. One sampled body appeared truncated. A further seven-report synonym sensitivity check found no additional qualifying gun-taking shooting. These checks are not a human gold standard, measured recall, or assurance that unlisted, differently worded or missing news was captured. 139 explicit recommendation tails were removed while raw bodies were retained.

The comparison therefore concerns **confirmed positive reports detected by a fixed, incomplete measurement process**. It does not estimate real-event incidence, whether police accounts are true, whether a shooting was legally justified, or a causal effect of BJP government. Source-context review and subagent agreement are disclosed AI assistance; independent human verification remains outstanding.

Sources and reproducibility

Government dates: West Bengal oath, PMO/PIB; Tamil Nadu Governor; Kerala oath, PMO; Telangana chief minister

Main event evidence: Baruipur; Gaighata; Combined October 27 report; Nizamabad/Riyaz

Additional parade evidence: Howrah reconstruction reports, Indian Express; Howrah date check, India Today

Methods: Abadie (2021), Synthetic Controls; Conley and Taber, few policy changes

Reproduce from event_coding/event_ledger.csv; analysis/detected_case_window_counts.csv; analysis/scm_gun_taking_police_shooting/{summary.json,trajectory.csv,weight_bounds.csv}; and this generating Python file. The synthetic plot uses those saved actual analysis outputs; no illustrative or simulated event observations are substituted. Full URLs, publication dates and date qualifications remain in the event ledger.

Public research repository: aritra1097/toi-police-practices-research. Research snapshot: 27 October 2026; TOI publication times just after midnight 28 October IST can precede the retrieval endpoint in New York. Event-window inclusion uses event dates.